Product Operating Model

Organise around long-lived products and the outcomes they create, not temporary projects and the features they ship.

Lead the Organisation · Inspired by Transformed (Marty Cagan, SVPG) and Project to Product (Mik Kersten)

ORGANISATION _____

DATE _____

1 Projects → products

Fund and staff long-lived products, not temporary projects whose teams break up at the end.

TOOLS IN THIS KIT

- Portfolio Kanban & Investment Mix
- Team Topology Design

WHERE ARE WE? 1 2 3 4 5 *1 = projects, 5 = products*

2 Output → outcomes

Judge success by changes in customer and business results, not by features shipped on time.

TOOLS IN THIS KIT

- Objectives & Key Results
- Value Metrics

WHERE ARE WE? 1 2 3 4 5 *1 = output, 5 = outcomes*

3 Feature teams → empowered teams

Give teams problems to solve, not features to build, and trust them to decide how.

TOOLS IN THIS KIT

- Delegation Board
- Team Charter

WHERE ARE WE? 1 2 3 4 5 *1 = feature teams, 5 = empowered teams*

4 Requirements → discovery

Test whether an idea is valuable, usable, feasible and viable before building it, quickly and cheaply.

TOOLS IN THIS KIT

- Opportunity Solution Tree
- Product Bet Canvas

WHERE ARE WE? 1 2 3 4 5 *1 = requirements, 5 = discovery*

5 Dated roadmaps → strategy and bets

Focus on the few problems that matter most, and say what you'll learn as well as what you'll ship.

TOOLS IN THIS KIT

- Product Vision Board
- Now · Next · Later Roadmap

WHERE ARE WE? 1 2 3 4 5 *1 = dated roadmaps, 5 = strategy and bets*

6 Order-taking → partnership

Product teams work with the rest of the business as partners, not as a service that takes orders.

TOOLS IN THIS KIT

- Stakeholder Map
- Impact Map

WHERE ARE WE? 1 2 3 4 5 *1 = order-taking, 5 = partnership*

When Building Gets Cheaper

WHAT AI CHANGES

Discovery matters more

When code is cheap, building the wrong thing becomes the expensive mistake.

Test more ideas, faster

Prototypes take hours, so run more experiments, each with a clear stop rule.

Teams can own more

Smaller teams can look after more, so watch for overload and slipping quality.

Judgement stays human

Name who is accountable for what AI decides and produces, at every stage.

Tools in this kit: AI in Delivery · AI Working Agreement · 1% Experiment Canvas

Signs It's Only a Rename

TICK WHAT YOU SEE

- [ ] Project managers retitled product managers, doing the same job
- [ ] Teams still handed lists of features with dates
- [ ] Funding still approved project by project
- [ ] Success still measured by on time and on budget
- [ ] No time for discovery: every idea goes straight to build
- [ ] Teams reshuffled every few months

Each tick points back to a shift above. Start with the one that hurts most.

"Which shift would make the biggest difference here, and what's stopping it?"

"What would we stop doing if teams owned outcomes?"

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